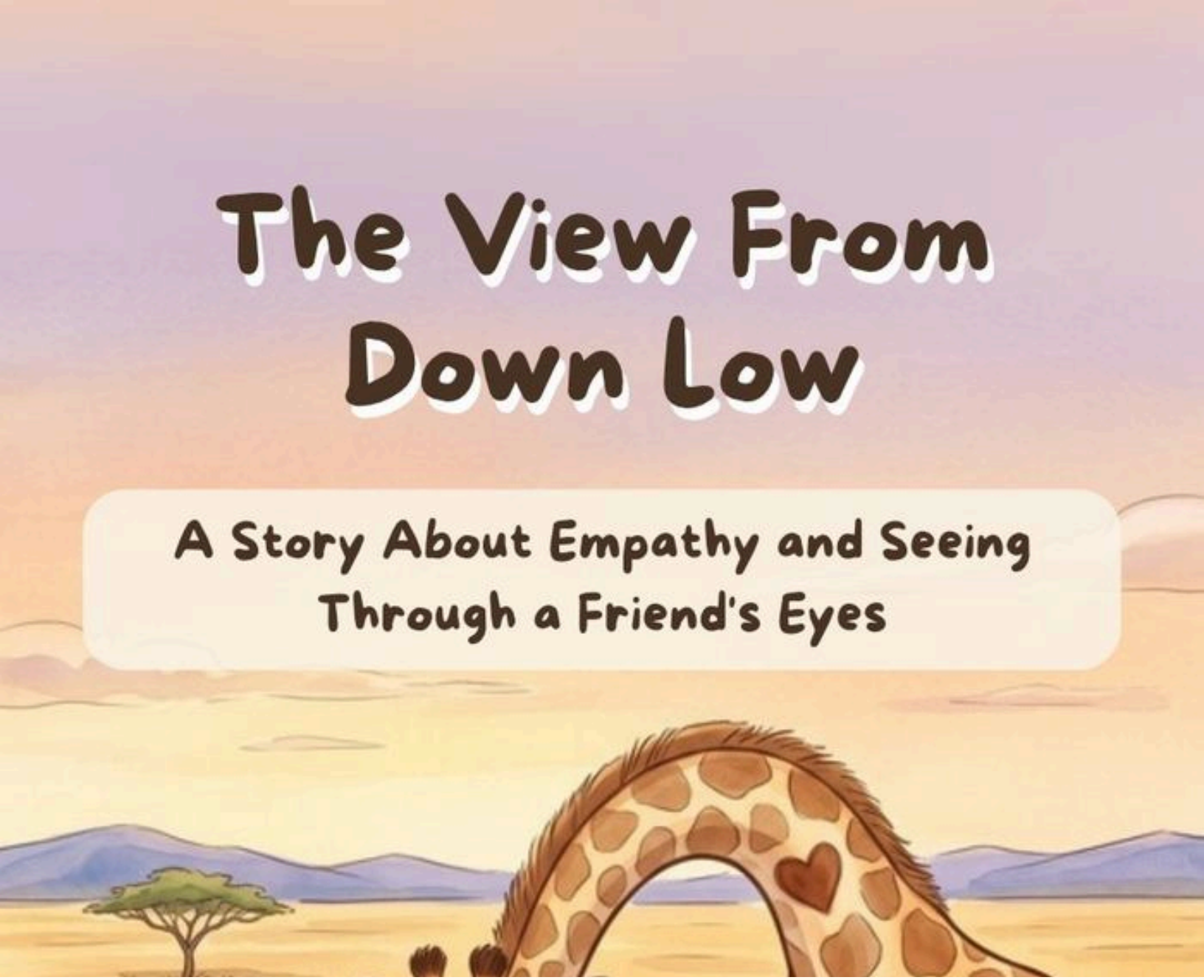


Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

The View From Down Low

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: empathy.

For use in your own home. Please don't share the file or post it online.

For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

To understand a friend, go to where they are and see what they see. Listen first, then help.

Say it together

Clomp, clomp, clomp!

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
tall	very high from top to bottom	stretch your hand up high
bend	to lean your body down	bend over and touch your knees
notice	to see or feel something you didn't see before	point to your eyes
listen	to pay attention to what someone says	cup your hand behind your ear
view	what you can see from where you are	make binoculars with your hands

A gentle note

Langa is kind, not a bully. Keep the message that we all miss things until we look from someone else's place.

Some children are smaller or use mobility aids. Keep the focus on seeing each other, never on any child's size or body.

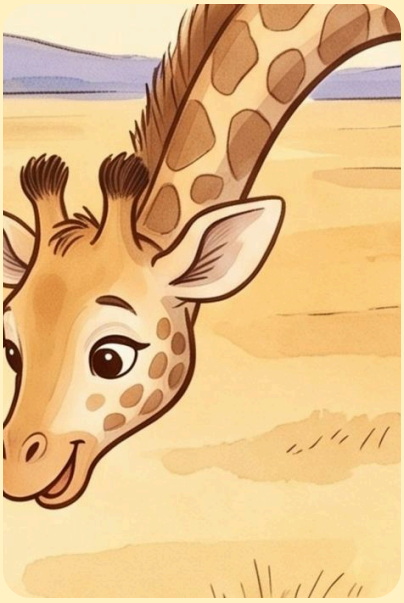
What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

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Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



Langa

Giraffe

The tallest one, learning to see what's down low



Themba

Meerkat

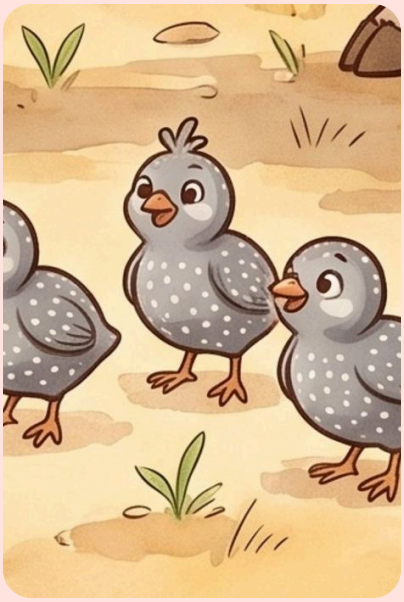
The small friend who shows Langa the view from down low



Kulu

Leopard tortoise

The slow, wise friend at the waterhole



The three chicks

Helmeted guineafowl keets

Little ones who can't reach the pods



The warthog twins

Common warthog

Muddy-nosed twins who need things low

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How did they feel?

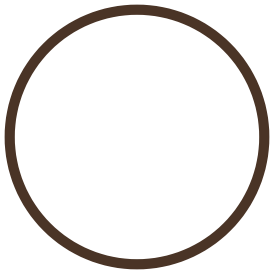
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

Themba sneezes in the dust; Langa says everything looks fine.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

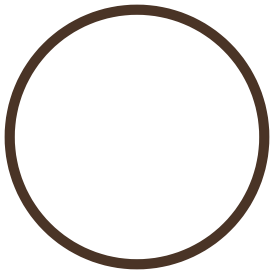


Moment 2

Dust puffs into Langa's eyes.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

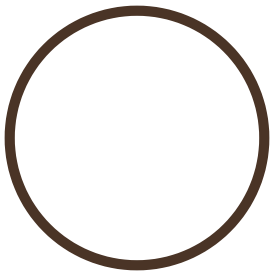


Moment 3

Themba says nothing, but Langa notices.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



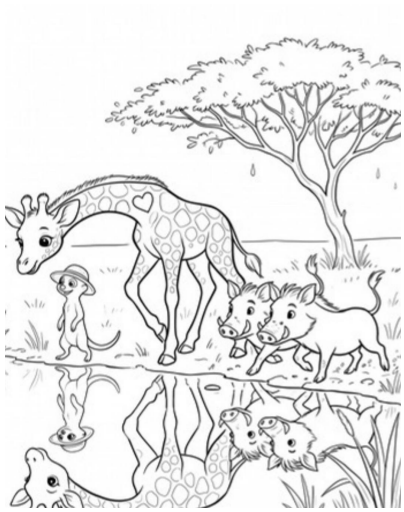
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Story in order

Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

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Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

tall very high from top to bottom

tall tall

bend to lean your body down

bend bend

notice to see or feel something you didn't see before

notice notice

Langa the hero of the story

Langa Langa

Write your name

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Draw your own story

Langa showed empathy. Draw a time when you showed empathy too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

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Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

Two views drawing

You need: Paper folded in half, crayons

On one half, draw what Langa sees from up high. On the other half, draw what Themba sees down low. Share with a partner.

Down low walk

Crouch down to a toddler's height and walk around your home. What can't you see from down there?

Up high look

Stand on a safe step with a grown-up. What new things can you see from up high?

Meerkat lookout

Take turns being the lookout while others play. Call out "kek-kek!" if you spot the 'eagle' (a grown-up).

Draw what you made

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The real animals

The animals in The View From Down Low are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



Langa

Giraffe

Giraffe moms give birth standing up, so the baby drops about 2 metres to the ground. Ouch! But within an hour it's standing.



Themba

Meerkat

Jackals, martial eagles and tawny eagles are a meerkat's most dangerous enemies. That's why the lookout always watches the sky.



Kulu

Leopard tortoise

Leopard tortoise eggs take 240 to 400 days to hatch. That's up to more than a year!



The three chicks

Helmeted guineafowl keets

When danger comes, the whole flock shouts a loud rattling "kek-kek-kek-krrrrr" that gets faster and faster.

Story or real?

Real giraffes really do have trouble bending down: it's a wobbly, risky move. But a giraffe's horns, called ossicones, are real, and its heart-shaped neck patch is our artist's idea.

Where they really live

The book's golden plain has no name, so we picked a real place where giraffes, meerkats, leopard tortoises, guineafowl and warthogs all live: Tswalu Kalahari Reserve in South Africa.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-view-from-down-low

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Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



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Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

Who is tall and who is small? What do you think each of them can see?

The View From Down Low, talk card 1

Why didn't Langa notice that his friends were unhappy?

The View From Down Low, talk card 2

How did it feel for Langa to bend all the way down?

The View From Down Low, talk card 3

What did he learn when he was down low?

The View From Down Low, talk card 4

How did he know Themba wanted to see the sunset?

The View From Down Low, talk card 5

When could you 'bend down' to see how a friend feels?

The View From Down Low, talk card 6

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Empathy hero

This is to say that

_____

showed empathy, just like Langa.

Clomp, clomp, clomp!

Signed _____ Date _____

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